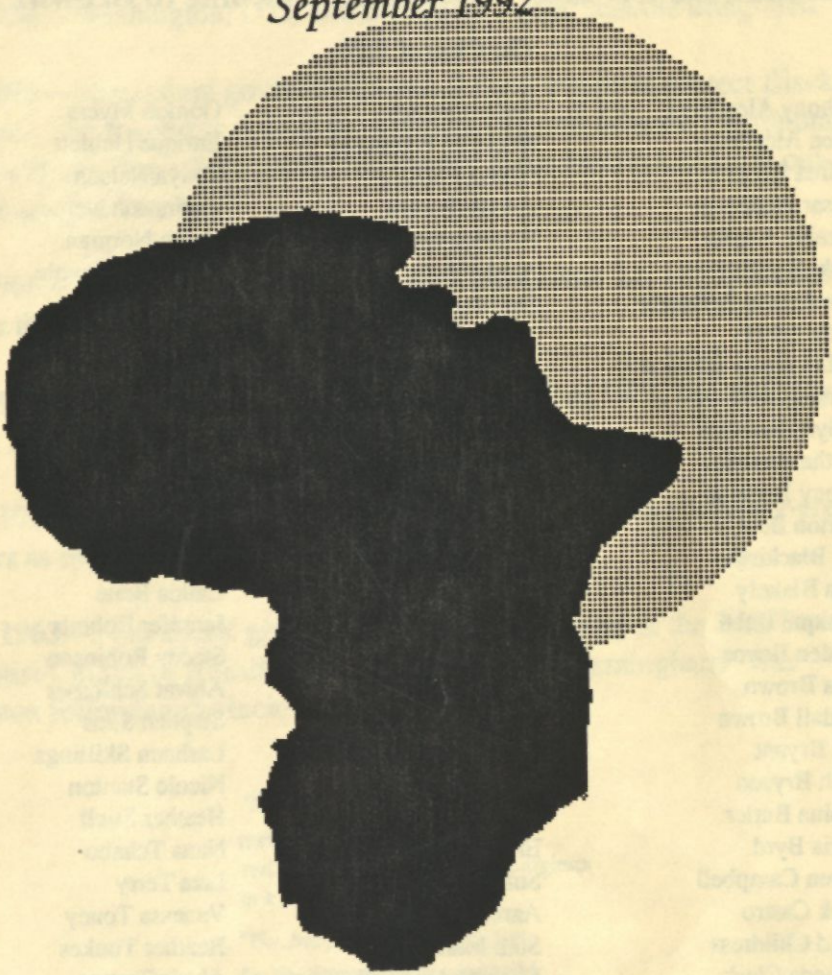
African Sun

September 1992



From the Editors...

What's up y'all? On the behalf of the African Sun staff we would like to extend a welcome back to the returning members of the Brown Black community. But first and foremost, we'd like to issue a welcome to the Class of 1996. Each new class has something to add to the community. We are glad that you are here to contribute your energy, your talents and your ideas. Once again... **Welcome to Brown!**

The Class of 1996

Anthony Alexander
Karen Alexander
Andrea Anderson
Caesar Anderson
Lorraine Anglin
Mark Aradeon
Yaw Asamoah-Duodu
Corey Atkins
Rachel Ayala Johnson
Shannon Bell
Evelyn Benedict
Martha Benyam
Quincy Berstine
Everton Best
Eric Blackiston
Pieta Blakely
Monique Bobb
Hayden Boyce
Dana Brown
Randall Brown
Oris Bryant
Sarah Bryson
Shinina Butler
Derria Byrd
Darren Campbell
Frank Castro
Lloyd Childress
Melanca Clark
Roslyn Clarke
Jarita Davis
Stephanie Davis
Kwame Denianke
Fania Denton
Yohance Edwards
Darianne Elliot
Hubert Fenton
Michelle Ferdinand
Nonya Fiakpui
Adrian Forbes
Rhonica Galloway
Mark Ghaly
Daphne Gilles
Edward Goveia
Michelle Graham
Aliah Greene
Tanya Hall
Misao Higashi
Malaika Hilliard
Alvin Huff
Alexis Hunter
Kenyana Johns
Dorian Johnson
Christopher Jones
Tanya Jones
James Joseph
Sean Knowles
Ebony Lee
Keith Lee
Ellen Lucas
Sofia Mahari
Aaron Malick
Sudi Malloy
Michele Marshall
Lateisha Mason
Jennifer Mbuthia
Jolene McAuley
Sandra McDaniel
Elmer Merry
Jeffrey Mingo
Cynthia Mohammed
Christen Morrow
Gordon Myers
Enrique Neblett
Tonya Nelson
Dufirstson Neree
Bryan Norman
Ayodeji Oyewole
Amilca Palmer
Adrienne Phillips
Adrienne Pica
Nicole Pope
Zawadi Powell
Danielle Pulliam
Mark Queen
Heather Reid
Patrice Reid
Cathia Rene
Jennifer Roberts
Stacey Robinson
Ahwat Schlosser
Stephen Silas
Lashaun Skillings
Nicole Stanton
Heather Stiell
Nana Tchabo
Liza Terry
Vanessa Toney
Heather Tookes
Alysia Turner
Tamra Tyree
Iman Tyson
Althea Wasow
Nicole Williams
Bryan Yee
Deborah York
Robyn Young

HISTORICAL EVENTS IN SEPTEMBER

3, 1979—Robert Naynard is named editor-publisher of the *Oakland Tribune-East Bay Today*, becoming the first Black to head a major daily newspaper.

7, 1954—Washington, D.C. and Baltimore public schools integrated.

8, 1875—Mississippi govenor requests federal troops to protect Black voters. The request is denied by Attorney General Edward Pierrepont who replies, "the whole public are tired of these annual autumnal outbreaks in the South...."

9, 1966—Constance Baker Motley, born September 14, 1921, is sworn in as the first Black female federal judge.

9, 1968—Tennis star Arthur Ashe Jr., now battling HIV, becomes the first Black to win the U.S. Open.

12, 1974—Haile Selassie is deposed by military leaders after fifty-eight years as the ruling monarch of Ethiopia.

15, 1963—Four Black girls are killed in the bombing of the 16th Street Baptist Church in Birmingham, AL. "Ballad of Birmingham" was written following the incident.

"Ballad of Birmingham"

"Mother dear, may I go downtown
instead of out to play,
and march the streets of Birmingham
in a freedom march today?"

"No, baby, no, you may not go,
for the dogs are fierce and wild,
and clubs and hoses, guns and jails
ain't good for a little child."

"But, mother, I won't be alone.
Other children will go with me,
and march the streets of Birmingham
to make our country free."

"No, baby, no, you may not go,
for I fear those guns will fire.
But you may go to Church instead,
and sing in the children's choir."

She has combed and brushed her night dark hair,
and bathed rose petal sweet,
and drawn white gloves on her small brown hands,
and white shoes on her feet.

The mother smiled to know her child
was in the sacred place,
but that smile was the last smile
to come upon her face.

For when she heard the explosion,
her eyes grew wet and wild.
She raced through the streets of Birmingham
calling for her child.

She clawed through bits of glass and brick,
then lifted out a shoe.
"O, here's the shoe my baby wore,
but, baby, where are you?"
—Dudley Randall

17, 1983—Vanessa Williams, now an award-winning songstress, becomes the first Black woman named Miss America.

18, 1895—Booker T. Washington delivers his famous "Atlanta Compromise" address.

19, 1893—E.R. Robinson patents his electric railway trolley.

26, 1937—Singer Bessie Smith dies of injuries sustained in an automobile accident

29, 1910—The National Urban League is founded.

30, 1962—Under the protection of federal troops and after a lengthy legal battle, James Meredith enrolls as the first Black student at the University of Mississippi.

Contact Persons for Black Student Organizations 1992-93

African Students Association	Bidemi Carrol	x4563
Alpha Kappa Alpha Sorority	Regine Ostine	x6678
Alpha Phi Alpha Fraternity	Rahsan Lindsay	x5132
Black Pre-Medical Society	Nicole Brewer	x6419
Black Voices Alafia	Clair Chester	x6523
Brown Sisters United	AngeliqueAnderson	x4989
Delta Sigma Theta Sorority	Nina Guercio	?
Fruit of the Spirit	Chris Moses	x6120
Kappa Alpha Psi Fraternity	Hardy Bright	x6578
Kulcha Kollectiv	Rod Bowen	x6301
Lambda Upsilon Lambda	Julian Llanas	?
NAACP	Evelyn Wande	x5069
Nat'l Society of Black Engineers	Ayanna MacCalla	x6511
The Next Thing	Ed Brockenbrough	x6179
Omega Psi Phi Fraternity	?	?
Onyx	?	?
OUAP	K. Lazarre-White	x4556
Pan-Hellenic Council	A. Blanchette	x6416
Phi Beta Sigma Fraternity	Bruce Strothers	x6164
Psychology Students of Color	?	?
Sigma Lambda Upsilon	Alina Ocasio	x4798
Shades of Brown	Nicole Brewer	x6419
Sigma Gamma Rho Sorority	A. Blanchette	x6416
Students of Caribbean Ancestry	Linda Smith	x6376
Third World Pre-Business Soc.	David Hirsch	?
Third World Pre-Law Society	?	?
Voices of Inspiration	Deila Davis	x6183
Women of Color Collective	Dawn Adams	x4989
Zeta Phi Beta Sorority	Yulisa Cruz	x5008

If there are any errors or missing information in the chart above, please inform the co-editors. To have your organization's upcoming events listed in *African Sun* 's October calendar, please contact J. Omari Johnson (X6206) by September 28th.

A Letter From The Co-Chairs

We as the co-chairs of the Organization of United African People, see this year as extremely important to the future of O.U.A.P. O.U.A.P. is the voice for Black students at Brown. It is a political tool for ensuring that Black issues are dealt with. It must be even more. It must have more power. All of us, as African-American students at Brown, must ensure that O.U.A.P. follows the right path; the path of strength and activism. Our first goal as O.U.A.P. chairs is to strengthen the organization by increasing the participation, and by raising and obtaining more money. Through this, the aspirations of Black students can be met. It will be a struggle to ensure that O.U.A.P.'s voice is one to be reckoned with, it will be a struggle to ensure that O.U.A.P. will be able to change Brown in the better interests of African-American students. But, as Frederick Douglass once brilliantly said, "If there is no struggle, there is no progress." If Black students at Brown come together, and work as one collective body, then there will be progress.

O.U.A.P. will continue to have the various forums that serve as places for the Black community to express our views. O.U.A.P. will bring speakers to this campus to address issues that are important to us, as a people. For instance, we are already trying to have one of the leaders of the African National Congress come to Brown, to speak on the situation in South Africa. As the Black student union at Brown, it is O.U.A.P.'s responsibility to make information accessible to Black students on how we can become more involved in Providence's Black community. White students can not be the pervasive participants on the work in these communities, Black participation is vital.

This year O.U.A.P. will begin negotiations with the Brown administration to establish a Black House at Brown. A cultural, historical and political place where Black students can come together and talk, think, chill or simply get away. As the famous scholar bell hooks once wrote, "When a people no longer have the space to construct home place, we cannot build meaningful community or resistance." We, as Black students, need a space of our own. Most other colleges have one, and Brown must too. We need a "home place," a house where we can establish a sense of community and cohesiveness.

Let us come together to make O.U.A.P. strong. Let us have a powerful voice to reckoned with. Now is the time.

Libero Della Piana
Khary Lazarre-White

(The co-chairs wanted to express their gratitiude for the showing at the first general OUAP meeting. There were nearly 100 students there, which is about 25% of the Black population at Brown.)

As Easy As 1...2...E

OUAP is an umbrella organization for all of the Black groups on campus. The Executive Board, E-Board, is the ruling body of OUAP comprised of representatives from various committees within the organization. The following is a list of those committees, a brief description of what they do and the contact person(s).

The **Co-Chairs of OUAP** for 1992-93 are Libero Della Piana (831-7185) and Khary Lazarre-White (X4556).

The co-editors of ***African Sun*** are Ed Brockenbrough (X6179) and Milda Saunders (X4575).

The **Campus Minority Affairs Committee** serves as a direct link from the Third World Community to the Administration. OUAP's representative is Heather Grady (X6417).

The **Communications Committee** is responsible for disseminating information throughout the community about OUAP and other Black-sponsored events. It is headed by Gila Hilliard (X6599) and Jacques Louis (X4556).

The **Community Affairs Committee** is responsible for developing ways for Blacks at Brown to help one another and the greater Providence community through a variety of service based programs. The contact persons are Nadirah Moreland (X6392) and Joelle Murchison (X6271).

The **Liaison for the Center for the Study of Race and Ethnicity** serves as a link between the Center and the student groups. OUAP's representative is Delia Alexander (X5822).

The **Minority Review Committee** is responsible for viewing the admission packets of students of color for the upcoming class. OUAP's representatives are Brickson Diamond (X4722) and Camille Gear (X4914).

The **Third World Awareness Committee** works to help promote intracultural awareness within the Black community as well as intercultural awareness among the various Third World groups by sponsoring forums and other programs. It is headed by J. Omari Johnson (X6206) and Kim O'Neale (X6600).

The **Third World Coalition Committee** serves as a united political voice for issues that effect the Third World community. N. Jeremi Duru (X4556) and Eder Williams (X4795) are OUAP's representatives.

The **Treasurer**, Evelyn Wande (X5069) is responsible for all things relating to money including the budget and fundraising.

Uwezo is the showcase for Black creativity featuring literary and visual works. The contact persons are Ama Schulman (X5824) and Chris Meyers.

Policy Statement

The *African Sun* is a monthly publication which discusses the concerns of the Black Community at Brown. Its purpose is to foster constructive dialogue between African-American students on the problems and issues which confront us on a predominantly white campus. The *African Sun* is distributed to all Black students at Brown, making it an effective medium for African-American students to make their voices heard within the community. All members of the African-American community are encouraged to submit articles and editorials for publication in the *African Sun*.

1. All submissions must be written in Microsoft Word and saved on a Mac disk.
2. All submissions must be handed in by the deadline for the upcoming issue.

   9/29 for the October issue
   10/26 for the November issue
   11/30 for the December issue

3. Submissions can be handed in on a disk to one of the co-editors or to a member of the staff. Please label the disk with your name and telephone number so that it can be returned to you.
4. Anonymous submissions must be given directly to one of the co-editors.
5. The *African Sun* co-editors and staff reserve the right to edit all submissions for content and form in conjunction with the authors.

F.Y.I. ...

September:

24—*Spell #7*, a play by Ntozake Shange, runs 9/24-9/27 and 9/30-10/4, Leeds Theater, 8pm.

28—Meeting concerning the Black Experience at Brown, Salomon 101, 7pm.

October:

9-10—Kulcha Kollectiv will sponsor Mama Etta's, a jazz/blues cabaret. Rites and Reasons Theater, time TBA.

**A special thanks to Nadirah Moreland whose help and advice were indispensible in putting together this issue.